

The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter



Photograph: AP

Donald Trump demanded that a number of Gulf countries make peace with Israel after the Iran war ends. America's president said it should be "mandatory" for Saudi Arabia and Qatar to join the [Abraham Accords](#), which recognise Israel, followed by others, including Pakistan, Turkey, Egypt, and Jordan. Refusal would be seen as "bad intentions", he said. Mr Trump also said that [talks with Iran](#) were "proceeding nicely".

Oil prices dropped to their [lowest level](#) in more than two weeks amid hope that the **Strait of Hormuz** would soon be fully reopened. Meanwhile, a handful of ships made their way through the waterway. They included a supertanker that crossed the American blockade line with around 2m barrels of Iraqi crude and sailed for China after being trapped for nearly three months.

Russia warned foreigners in Kyiv to leave the Ukrainian capital ahead of "systemic strikes" targeting defence facilities. The Russian defence ministry said these were a response to a deadly [Ukrainian attack](#) on a student dorm in the Russian-occupied Luhansk region. Separately, Russia's president, Vladimir Putin, signed a law to allow his country's army to intervene abroad to help Russian citizens.

Bolivia's centrist president, Rodrigo Paz, said he would cut his salary in half, as well as those of other members of his government, to appease protestors calling for his resignation. His government, which is just six months into its term, has faced [weeks of demonstrations](#) calling for an end to austerity measures. It insists those are necessary to fix public finances.

The World Health Organisation raised the threat posed by the **Ebola outbreak** in the Democratic Republic of Congo from “high” to “very high”. The suspected death toll has reached 119; a further 900 cases are suspected. Officials have banned funeral wakes and gatherings of more than 50 people to prevent the virus from spreading. The strain behind the outbreak currently has no approved vaccine or specific treatment.

Inmates in **Venezuela** launched a protest to demand the resignation of the director of the Barinas prison over human-rights abuses. They claim that he has allowed guards to shoot unarmed prisoners. The protestors set fire to piles of mattresses on the roof of the complex, which is some 500km west of Caracas, the capital; they say that guards have responded with fire, wounding some protesters.

Only one world record was broken at the inaugural **Enhanced Games**, a sports tournament at which athletes were allowed to use [performance-enhancing drugs](#). Kristian Gkolomeev, a Greek swimmer, finished the men's 50m freestyle in 20.81 seconds, .07 seconds quicker than the official record. The [contentious event in Las Vegas](#), which aimed at pushing the limits of the human body with steroids and banned supplements, had several clean winners.

Figure of the day: Around **5.7m**, the number of Indonesians on a waiting list for the *hajj*. [Read about](#) how the Iran war has not deterred Asian pilgrims.



Photograph: Getty Images

USMCA under pressure

Mexico escaped the worst of Donald Trump's tariff barrage last year. Goods covered by the [United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement](#) were exempted, shielding most of Mexico's exports to America. The carve-out mattered. North America's supply chains are tightly intertwined, with cars and components crossing the border many times during production. Protected from the highest tariffs, Mexico has strengthened its position as America's dominant trading partner, supplying around a sixth of America's imports by value.

Now that agreement faces a big test. This week American and Mexican officials meet in Mexico City to begin [USMCA](#) negotiations. America wants tighter restrictions on Chinese inputs into North American supply chains. Mexico wants relief from [steel, aluminium and car tariffs](#). It has already raised barriers on Chinese goods to appease Mr Trump. But that may not have been enough. With the July deadline for [USMCA](#)'s six-year review approaching, a full renegotiation looks unlikely. Instead, the agreement may slip into annual review cycles, extending uncertainty for businesses across North America.



Photograph: Getty Images

America mourns its Iran war dead

As Americans celebrate memorial day on Monday, Donald Trump has asked that they observe a moment of remembrance for the 13 service members who have died in the Iran war. That conflict is deeply unpopular and has dragged the president's [approval rating](#) to its nadir—57% of Americans disapprove of his performance. Might it end imminently? A truce, he says, is “largely negotiated” with details to come soon.

A resolution could not come soon enough for Republicans in Congress, who face a drubbing in the midterms in November. Average petrol prices are 40% higher than a year ago, and Democrats are hammering away about affordability. And yet, in spite of the fiasco of the Iran war, Mr Trump's tendency to overreach is unabated. Even Republicans are bristling at his \$1.8bn “anti-weaponisation” fund, which promises payouts for his supporters. No doubt lawmakers are studying *The Economist's* [midterms forecast model](#), which predicts Democrats will win the House, and maybe even the Senate.



Photograph: Getty Images

Ferrari goes electric

The most expensive electric cars have so far been a hard sell. Ferrari will hope that the Luce, launched on Monday in Rome, is a winner like the Rolls-Royce Spectre, a luxury coupe, rather than following in the tyre tracks of the less successful Rimac Nevera or Pininfarina Battista hypercars. (Ferrari is part-owned by Exor, which also part-owns the parent company of *The Economist*.)

The Italian supercar firm has drip-fed information about its battery-powered model adorned with the famous prancing-horse logo, unveiling technical information and giving a peek into its cabin well before the final reveal. But maybe the firm need not have tried so hard to create a buzz. Although the car will start at €550,000 (\$638,000), many wealthy collectors will want one in their garage. Moreover, to get on the waiting list for more exotic models, customers have to demonstrate their loyalty to the brand (by buying a Luce). For the less well-heeled car nut, even the sighting of a new Ferrari is an event to look forward to on the automotive calendar.



Photograph: AP

Pope Leo's AI encyclical

Pope Leo's first encyclical, published on Monday, will not go down well in the [White House](#). The *Magnifica Humanitas* (or “Magnificent Humanity”) is largely a call to prevent [artificial intelligence from dominating or replacing humankind](#). The pontiff calls for the slower development of AI and “robust legal frameworks”, which the American administration has been wary of introducing.

But Leo also uses the document to challenge a wide range of ideas and activities that President Trump and his associates support. He describes the “just war” theory used by the vice-president, JD Vance, to vindicate the attack on Iran as “outdated”. He criticises the emergence of a techno-oligarchy and the use of job cuts to boost profits. He warns of the risks of attaching AI to weapons and of the danger of social control arising from the mass collection of personal data. Many conservatives who rejoiced at the election of an American pope will sour on reading his broadside.



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Monday: Which Republican Senator from Virginia was married to Elizabeth Taylor?

*For every minute you are angry
you lose sixty seconds of
happiness.*

Ralph Waldo Emerson